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Astronomer winks at viral notoriety with ‘temporary spokesperson’ Gwyneth Paltrow



Anthony Ha — 12:40 PM PDT · July 26, 2025

After spending the past week-plus in the headlines due to a seemingly inescapable social media scandal, data operations startup [Astronomer](#) is trying to shift the narrative with a tongue-in-cheek video starring actress and entrepreneur Gwyneth Paltrow.

Paltrow was, of course, previously married to Coldplay singer Chris Martin. And it was at a Coldplay concert in Massachusetts that the company's CEO Andy Byron and chief people officer Kristin Cabot were apparently caught dancing together on the "kiss cam."

IMAGE CREDITS: ASTRONOMER

When Byron and Cabot (who are reportedly married to other people) awkwardly tried to hide from the camera, Martin joked, "Either they're having an affair or they're just very shy."

Footage of the exchange exploded in popularity, ultimately leading both executives to [resign from Astronomer](#). In announcing Byron's resignation, the company said, "Our leaders are expected to set the standard in both conduct and accountability, and recently, that standard was not met."

Astronomer's statement also nodded at the fact that the company had suddenly become famous for reasons having nothing to do with its product: "While awareness of our company may have changed overnight, our product and our work for our customers have not."

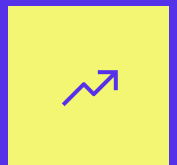
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Its [new marketing video](#) has a similar message, attempting to refocus the conversation on Astronomer’s technology, while winkingly acknowledging why that might be a challenge.

Paltrow kicks things off by introducing herself as someone who’s been “hired on a very temporary basis to speak on behalf of the 300-plus employers at Astronomer.” She then promises to answer the “most common” questions asked about the company — but when the briefly glimpsed, half-typed questions are all about you-know-what, Paltrow remains cheerfully, and resolutely, on-message.

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“We’ve been thrilled so many people have a newfound interest in data workflow automation,” she says. Paltrow even finds time to plug the company’s upcoming conference before concluding, “We will now be returning to what we do best — delivering game-changing results for our customers.”



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Anthony Ha



Anthony Ha is TechCrunch’s weekend editor. Previously, he worked as a tech reporter at Adweek, a senior editor at...

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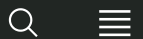


Netflix and Gwyneth Paltrow's 'Goop Lab' will launch on January 24

Anthony Ha — 6:47 PM PST · January 6, 2020

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In fact, the company also released an eyebrow-raising poster today, with the tagline “reach new depths.”

Gwyneth Paltrow welcomes you to The Goop Lab on January 24 pic.twitter.com/ZzeEEbAy9L

— Netflix Queue (@netflixqueue) [January 6, 2020](#)

And if you watch the trailer, you'll see that the topics will include energy healing, psychedelics, cold therapy, psychic mediums and orgasms. At one point, Goop's chief content officer, Elise Loehnen (who's co-hosting with Paltrow), declares, “What we try to do at Goop is explore ideas that may seem out there or too scary.”

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The show was [first announced in February 2019](#). It will premiere on January 24.

This may also be a good time to remind people of Netflix CEO [Reed Hastings’ remarks last year](#), in response to questions about the decision to pull an episode of Hasan Minaj’s “Patriot Act” in Saudi Arabia: “We’re not in the truth to power business, we’re in the entertainment business.”



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Gwyneth Paltrow’s Goop to pay for making unsubstantiated claims about vaginal Jade eggs

Kate Clark — 9:04 AM PDT · September 5, 2018

Goop, the lifestyle and e-commerce site **started by** Hollywood darling Gwyneth Paltrow, has settled a \$125,000 lawsuit connected to false advertisements of a **\$66 vaginal Jade egg**, which the company said balanced hormones, prevented uterine prolapse and more.

Scientists begged to differ. According to the lawsuit, **filed with the Santa Clara County District Attorney**, the “wellness empire sold a series of women’s health products whose advertised medical claims were not supported by competent and reliable science.”

“The health and money of Santa Clara County residents should never be put at risk by misleading advertising,” District Attorney Jeff Rosen said in a statement. “We will vigilantly protect consumers against companies that promise health benefits without the support of good science...or any science.”

Here’s what Goop had to say: “Goop provides a forum for practitioners to present their views and experiences with various products like the Jade egg. The law, though, sometimes views statements like this as advertising claims, which are subject to various legal requirements,” CFO Erica Moore said in a statement. “The Task Force assisted us in applying those laws to the content we published, and we appreciate their guidance in this matter as we move from a pioneer in this space to an established wellness authority.”

Among the false claims made by Goop were that the Jade and Rose Quartz egg-shaped stones were capable of balancing hormones, regulating menstrual cycles and increasing bladder control. None of those claims were substantiated.

The company is known for selling bizarre products with hefty price tags, including a \$2,400 spirit-

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animal ring and 18k gold dumbbells priced at \$125,000.

The good news is, if you were among the buyers of the falsely advertised Jade Egg, Goop is now willing to refund the full purchase.



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Actress-turned-entrepreneur [Gwyneth Paltrow](#) has [raised \\$82 million in venture capital funding for Goop](#) to date from NEA, Lightspeed Venture Partners, Felix Capital and others.

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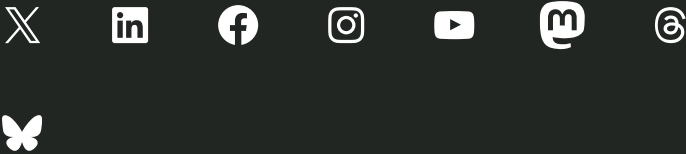
Kate Clark

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Kate Clark was a reporter at TechCrunch covering venture capital and startups.

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